

EMAIL INVESTIGATION REPORT

Email Analysis Playbook | SOC-EML-001

Case Information

Case ID	
Analyst	
Date / Time (UTC)	
Alert Source	
Priority	
Playbook Version	

Executive Summary

VERDICT	CONFIDENCE	ACTION	RISK

One-line summary:

Email Metadata

Subject	
From (Display Name)	
From (Email Address)	
Reply-To	
Return-Path	
To	
Date Sent	
Message-ID	

Recipient Context

Recipient Role	
User Action	
Business Impact	

Technical Analysis

Module 1: Header Analysis

Total Hops	
Origin IP	
Origin Hostname	
Submission Type	
Transport Security	
Header Integrity	
Timestamp Anomalies	
Clock Skew	

Analyst Notes:

Module 2: Authentication Results

SPF Result	
SPF Aligned	
DKIM Result	
DKIM Signing Domain	
DKIM Aligned	
DMARC Result	
DMARC Policy	
ARC Chain	
Authentication Score (0-100)	

Analyst Notes:

Module 3: Origin Attribution

Origin IP	
ASN	
Organization	
Country	
Infrastructure Classification	
AbuseIPDB Score	
VirusTotal Detections	
Previous Emails from this IP	
Origin Risk Level	

Analyst Notes:

Module 4: Spoofing and Impersonation Analysis

Spoofing Status	
From vs Return-Path	
Lookalike Domain Detected	
Levenshtein Distance	
Homoglyph Detection	
Display Name Impersonation	
Reply-To Mismatch	
VIP Targeting	
Impersonation Type	

Checks performed:

- From vs Return-Path mismatch
- Lookalike domain detection

- Homoglyph detection
- Display name impersonation
- Reply-To mismatch
- VIP impersonation attempt

Analyst Notes:

Module 5: Content Analysis

Intent Classification	
Urgency Language	
Authority Language	
Threat Language	
Financial Keywords	
Credential Keywords	
Brand Impersonation	
Content Risk Score (0-100)	

Keywords detected:

- Financial (invoice, payment, wire transfer)
- Credential (verify, login, password reset)
- Urgency (immediate, urgent, expires, 24 hours)
- Authority (CEO, CFO, IT Department, Security Team)
- Threat (suspended, locked, legal action, deleted)

Email body summary:

Module 6: Link Analysis

URL	Shortener?	Final Destination	Risk

Link findings:

- URL shorteners detected

- Display text mismatch
- Redirect chains present
- Malicious links confirmed
- Suspicious domains

Analyst Notes:

Module 7: Attachment Analysis

Filename	Type	Size	Hash (SHA256)	Reputation	Risk

Attachment findings:

- Dangerous file types (.exe, .scr, .bat, .vbs, .js)
- Macro-enabled documents (.docm, .xlsm, .pptm)
- Macros detected inside document
- Extension vs MIME type mismatch
- Known malware hash
- Password-protected archive

Risk Scoring

Phishing Risk Score (0-100)	
Authentication Score (0-100)	
Content Risk Score (0-100)	
Origin Risk Score (0-100)	

Phishing Score — Contributing Factors

Factor	Points
TOTAL (cap 100)	

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IP Address(es)	
Sender Domain(s)	
Sender Email	
Reply-To Email	
URL(s)	
File Hash(es)	
Subject Line	

Response Actions

Immediate Actions Taken

- Email quarantined from recipient mailbox
- User notified
- Sender domain / IP blocked
- IOCs blocked at perimeter
- Similar emails searched across all mailboxes
- Endpoint scan initiated
- Credentials reset
- Escalated to IR team

Follow-up Actions Required

- Submit URL to sandbox (URLScan.io / ANY.RUN)
- Report IOCs to threat intel platforms
- Create or update detection rule
- Update security awareness training
- Notify executives

User Notification

Message sent to user:

Investigation Timeline

Time (UTC)	Event
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Total Time to Resolution: _____

Lessons Learned

What Worked Well

Detection Gaps Identified

Recommendations

Appendix — Raw Email Headers

Paste full raw headers here: